

Purpose:

Build a reliable, structured, and verifiable startup database for Ethiopia's startup ecosystem. This database will serve as the foundation for investor pipelines, ecosystem reports, and government partnerships.

1. Objectives

1. Collect structured startup data from events, applications, and ecosystem partners.
2. Verify startup information to ensure data reliability.
3. Maintain up-to-date, searchable, and relational data.
4. Enable investor access, analytics, and reporting.
5. Support future integration with the Formidable platform.

2. Core Features

2.1 Startup Profiles

Each startup profile should include:

- Startup Name
- Founders (names, roles, LinkedIn)
- Sector / Industry
- Stage (Idea, MVP, Seed, Series A)
- Product / Service Description
- Traction Metrics (users, revenue, partnerships)
- Funding Details (rounds, investors, amount)

- Location (city, country)
- Number of employees
- Formidable Verification Level (Level 1–4)
- Documents (optional: pitch deck, registration certificate)

2.2 Founder Profiles

- Personal Information (name, contact, LinkedIn, past experience)
- Role in startup
- Startup associations
- Verification status

2.3 Verification System

- Assign verification tiers:
 - Level 1: Registered startup
 - Level 2: Product / MVP verified
 - Level 3: Investor-ready due diligence
 - Level 4: Fully verified with financial/traction validation
- Store verification logs and documents

2.4 Data Submission & Updates

- Online startup application form
- Admin approval and validation workflow
- Automatic reminders for startups to update data quarterly
- Version history / timeline for each startup

2.5 Search & Filtering

- Filter by:
 - Sector / Industry
 - Stage
 - Location
 - Funding status
 - Verification level
- Keyword search in startup descriptions, founder names, etc.

2.6 Relationship Mapping

- Founder → Startup
- Startup → Investor
- Startup → Accelerator / Hub
- Startup → Corporate Partner
- Visualize connections in dashboard (optional for MVP)

2.7 Reporting & Analytics

- Generate reports for:
 - Investor deal flow
 - Funding trends
 - Sector growth
 - Verified startups per stage
- Export functionality (CSV, PDF)

3. Technical Requirements

- Database: SQL or NoSQL (PostgreSQL recommended for relational structure)
- Backend: API-driven (Node.js, Django, or Laravel)
- Frontend: Responsive admin dashboard + startup submission portal
- Security:
 - Role-based access control (Admin, Reviewer, Investor, Founder)
 - Data encryption at rest and in transit
 - Audit logs for updates / verifications
- Scalability: Support 10,000+ startups over 2 years

4. Data Sources & Integration

- Startup application submissions (events, online form)
- Partnerships with accelerators, hubs, universities
- Public business registration data
- Manual research for verification

Deliverables

1. Fully functional startup database
2. Startup submission portal
3. Admin dashboard for verification and updates
4. Searchable and filterable startup profiles
5. Reporting and analytics module

Notes / Guidelines

- Startups should never be published without verification.
- Keep the database modular for future platform integration.
- Prioritize data accuracy, security, and scalability over advanced UI features in MVP.
- Ensure easy export of data for investor dashboards and ecosystem reports.